

Thank you for sharing your thoughts on the AMIS Market Monitor. Results of the December survey can be found online: <http://www.amis-outlook.org/survey>



Market Monitor

No.25 – February 2015

www.amis-outlook.org

*The **Market Monitor** is a product of the [Agricultural Market Information System \(AMIS\)](http://www.amis-outlook.org). It covers the international markets for wheat, maize, rice and soybeans, giving a synopsis of major market developments and the policy and other market drivers behind them. The analysis is a collective assessment of the market situation and outlook by the ten international organizations that form the AMIS Secretariat. Ultimately, the report aims at improving market transparency and detecting emerging problems that might warrant the attention of policy makers.*

Contents

World Supply-Demand Outlook.....	1
Crop Monitor.....	2
Policy Developments.....	5
International Prices.....	6
Futures Markets	7
Monthly US Ethanol Update	8
Supplementary tables and charts.....	9
Explanatory Notes and Crop Calendar	12

World Supply-Demand Outlook

International prices of all AMIS crops have been sliding further since the previous report in December as large supplies continued to weigh on markets. Favourable prospects for crops to be harvested this year also contributed to the downward pressure. The strengthening of the US dollar and increasing volatility of national currencies are emerging as new features, with potential important impacts on the terms of trade.

	From December f'cast	From previous season
Wheat	■	▲
Maize	▼	▲
Rice	■	▼
Soybeans	▲	▲

▲ Easing ■ Neutral ▼ Tightening

WHEAT	million tonnes						
	USDA		IGC		FAO-AMIS		
	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 12-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 22-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 4-Dec	2014/15 f'cast 5-Feb
Production	714	723	713	717	715	725	724
Supply	889	909	882	904	874	900	899
Utilization	704	713	695	708	687	704	702
Trade	166	159	155	151	157	150	151
Ending Stock	186	196	187	196	175	193	192

- **Wheat** production forecast in 2014/15 slightly lowered, on smaller crop prospects in Europe, but still pointing to a record.
- Utilization to expand in 2014/15 after remaining steady for two consecutive seasons; sustained by higher consumption of food and feed.
- Trade in 2014/15 raised by 1 million tonnes, but still below the 2013/14 all-time high. Lower imports by China account for most of the anticipated decline in world trade
- Stocks (ending in 2015) to climb to their highest level in over a decade.

MAIZE	million tonnes						
	USDA		IGC		FAO-AMIS		
	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 12-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 22-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 4-Dec	2014/15 f'cast 5-Feb
Production	988	988	991	992	1010	1020	1020
Supply	1126	1160	1122	1167	1140	1196	1195
Utilization	953	971	947	973	945	971	972
Trade	131	112	120	114	124	114	115
Ending Stock	172	189	175	194	175	212	208

- **Maize** production in 2014 to exceed 2013 record, with sharp increases in the EU, South Africa and the US more than offsetting a decline in China and the CIS.
- Utilization in 2014/15 to increase by 2.8 percent as competitive prices boost global feed use of maize.
- Trade in 2014/15 raised by 1 million tonnes, but still below the 2013/14 all-time high. Lower imports by China account for most of the anticipated decline in world trade.
- Stocks (ending in 2015) reduced since December, on expectation of higher feed use, but still seen to hit a record.

RICE (milled)	million tonnes						
	USDA		IGC		FAO-AMIS		
	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 12-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 22-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 4-Dec	2014/15 f'cast 5-Feb
Production	477	475	475	474	497	496	496
Supply	587	582	587	584	672	677	677
Utilization	480	483	478	482	490	500	500
Trade	42	43	42	42	41	40	41
Ending Stock	107	99	109	102	181	177	178

- **Rice** production in 2014 to fall marginally short of the 2013 estimate, mostly reflecting declines in Asia.
- Utilization to rise by 10 million tonnes in 2014/15, surpassing production for the first time since 2005/06.
- Trade in 2015 to remain at around a 41 million tonne record reached in 2004, as competitive world prices sustain imports.
- Stocks (ending in 2015) revised up slightly, but still pointing to a drawdown of 3.5 million tonnes from 2014.

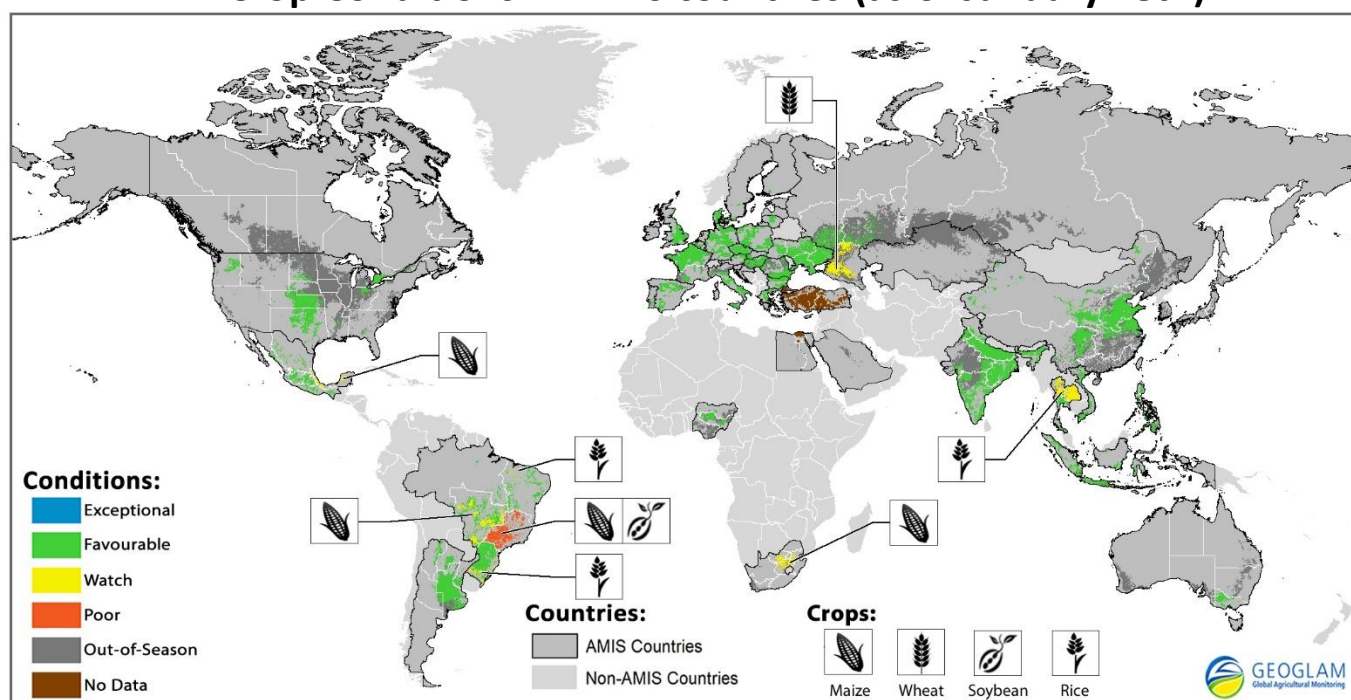
SOYBEANS	million tonnes						
	USDA		IGC		FAO-AMIS		
	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 12-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 22-Jan	2013/14 est.	2014/15 f'cast 4-Dec	2014/15 f'cast 5-Feb
Production	284	314	284	312	285	309	313
Supply	341	381	312	343	312	339	343
Utilization	272	286	281	300	282	297	300
Trade	113	116	111	116	114	118	120
Ending Stock	66	91	31	42	30	40	42

- **Soybean** production in 2014/15 revised upward on good harvest prospects in Brazil (notwithstanding irregular rainfall) and now poised to exceed last season's record by 10 percent.
- Utilization now seen surpassing 2013/14 level by 6.4 percent with competitive prices boosting demand.
- Trade in 2014/15 raised by 2.9 million tonnes on higher demand by China.
- Stocks (2014/15 carry-out) to bounce up more than anticipated earlier, with higher estimates for Brazil, the EU and China more than offsetting downward revisions in the US.

Estimates and forecasts may differ across sources for many reasons, including different methodologies. All changes, in absolute or percentage terms, reported in the supply/demand commentaries are calculated based on unrounded figures. For more information see the last page of this report.

Crop Monitor

Crop Conditions in AMIS countries (as of January 28th)



Crop condition map synthesizing information for all four AMIS crops as of January 28th. Crop conditions over the main growing areas for wheat, maize, rice, and soybean are based on a combination of national and regional crop analyst inputs along with earth observation data. **Crops that are in other than favourable conditions are displayed on the map with their crop symbol.**

Highlights

Wheat In the southern hemisphere harvest is complete and conditions at the end of the season were mixed in Australia and Argentina. In the northern hemisphere winter wheat is mostly dormant. In the EU, US, China, Ukraine and Canada the crop is dormant and progressing without any major concern. In Russia, conditions for the dormant crop are generally favourable except in the southern regions where there is some concern over limited protective snow cover and warmer than usual weather. In India, conditions are favourable.

Maize In the southern hemisphere conditions are mostly favourable. In Brazil, conditions are mostly favourable for the first crop however there is some concern over a delay in development due to the lack of rains in main producing areas and planting of the second crop has begun. In Argentina, planting is mostly complete and conditions remain generally favourable. In South Africa, Mexico and India, conditions are generally favourable.

Rice Conditions are favourable. In Thailand, harvest is almost complete for the wet season rice and conditions are generally favourable though there is some concern due to dryness. Dry season conditions are mixed due to dryness and cold weather. In India, Vietnam, Indonesia, and Philippines, conditions are generally favourable. In Brazil, conditions are mixed due to excessive rainfall in the southern region.

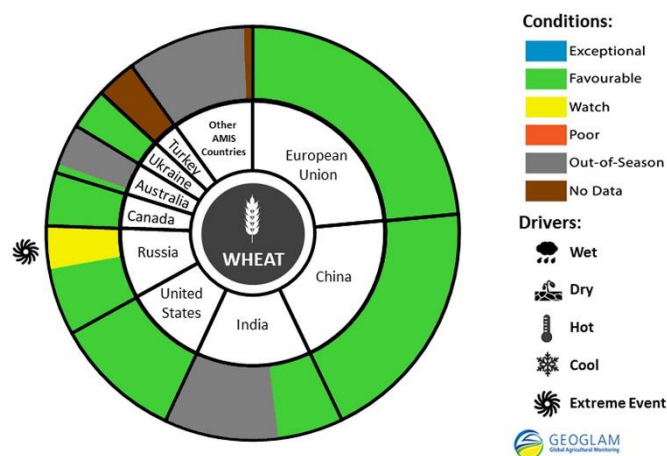
Soybeans In the southern hemisphere conditions are favourable. In Brazil, conditions are generally favourable though there is some concern over crop development in southern producing areas due to lack of rains. In Argentina, planting is progressing slowly but is mostly complete and conditions are generally good for both first and second soy.

El Niño situation update

The much anticipated El Niño of 2014/2015 has so far failed to materialize. While the U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) and the International Research Institute for Climate and Society (IRI) still foresee a 50 percent chance of oceanic and atmospheric conditions meeting the criteria for an El Niño declaration in February and March, the Australian Bureau of Meteorology (BOM) has reset its El Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) Tracker from "El Niño Alert" to "Neutral". BOM explains that El Niño conditions typically decay after January and that current model forecasts are consistent with this outlook. With all these expert determinations in mind, it is unlikely that the remainder of the southern hemisphere growing season will see the impacts of a classical El Niño event.

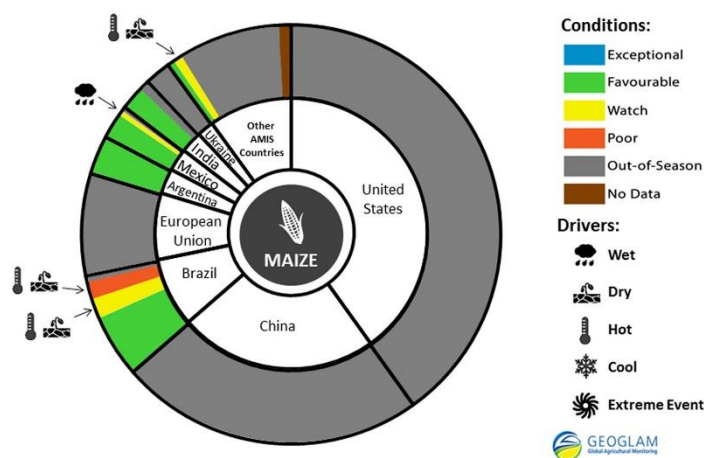
Wheat In the *southern hemisphere*, harvest is complete and conditions at the end of the season were mixed. In **Australia**, harvest was completed in all areas under generally favourable weather, though conditions were mixed due to dry hot weather earlier in the season. In **Argentina**, harvest is complete. Conditions were mixed due to variable weather conditions throughout the growing season. In the *northern hemisphere* winter wheat is mostly dormant. In the **EU**, the crop is dormant and progressing without concern. In the **US**, the crop is developing normally. In **China**, conditions are favourable for the dormant crop. In **Russia**, the crop is dormant and conditions are generally favourable. In the southern regions, there is some concern over limited snow cover and warmer than usual weather that thawed soils prematurely. Impacts, if any, will be determined in the spring. In **Canada**, the crop is dormant and progressing without concern. In **India**, conditions are favourable, and the crop is in vegetative to reproductive stages. In **Ukraine**, conditions are favourable for the dormant crop. Short periods of very cold temperatures occurred, though there was adequate snow to protect the crop. Warmer than usual temperatures followed in the south and western regions, leading to unstable snowcover, and soils thawing.

Wheat conditions for AMIS countries as of January 28th.



For detailed description of the pie chart please see box on page 4.

Maize conditions for AMIS countries as of January 28th.



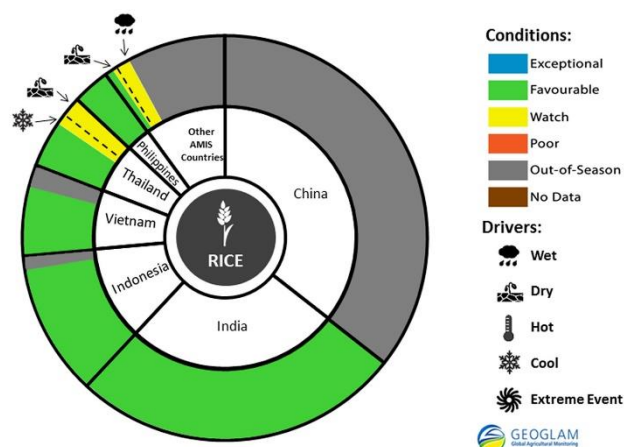
For detailed description of the pie chart please see box on page 4.

losses. In **Mexico**, conditions are favourable and harvest has begun for the spring-summer crop. Sowing of the autumn-winter crop has begun and conditions are also favourable. In **India**, harvest has begun and conditions are mostly favourable. There is some localized concern in a small area of the southern region due to moisture stress.

Maize In the *southern hemisphere*, conditions are mostly favourable. In **Brazil**, conditions are mostly favourable. However, there is concern over the first maize crop as there is a delay in development due to the lack of rains in main producing areas. Planting of the second maize crop (larger production) has begun. In **Argentina**, planting is mostly complete, though progressed slowly due to both excess and deficit moisture, and conditions are favourable. Rainfall in the northern regions has helped to moderate some of the higher temperatures in recent weeks. In **South Africa** conditions are generally favourable. Rainfall was predominantly abundant over the production region during the planting season. Hot and dry conditions during January with a more isolated to scattered nature of thunderstorms resulted in isolated areas experiencing

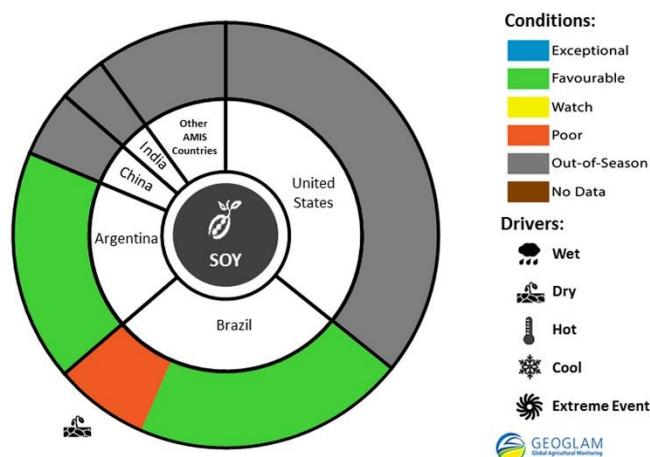
Rice conditions are favourable. In **India**, conditions are favourable and harvest is mostly complete for the first season of rice. Planting has begun for the second season crop, and the crop is in favourable condition. In **Thailand**, harvest is almost complete for the wet season rice, conditions are generally favourable, though there are some concerns over rice in the northeastern region due to dryness during the tillering stage. Dry season rice conditions are mixed due to insufficient water and cold weather. In **Viet Nam**, the summer crop is in good condition and harvest is progressing. The dry season rice is being transplanted and conditions are favourable. In **Indonesia**, the dry season crop is in good condition due to favourable weather. It is currently between vegetative to maturity stages. Planting has begun for the wet season crop, and conditions are good owing to adequate irrigation and sunlight. In **Brazil**, conditions are favourable, and development is proceeding normally despite excessive rainfall in the southern region, which is the main producing area. In the **Philippines**, dry season rice conditions are favourable owing to good weather. The crop is in tillering to panicle forming stages.

Rice conditions for AMIS countries as of January 28th.



For detailed description of the pie chart please see box below.

Soy Conditions for AMIS countries as of January 28th.



For detailed description of the pie chart please see box below.

Pie chart description: Each slice represents a country's share of total AMIS production (5-year average). Main producing countries (representing 90 percent of production) are shown individually, with the remaining 10 percent grouped into the "Other AMIS Countries" category. The area within each slice is divided between crops in-season (colour) and out-of-season (gray). The in-season portion is coloured according to the various crop conditions within that country. When conditions are labelled as 'poor' or 'watch', icons are added that provide information on the key climatic drivers affecting conditions. The coloured areas reflect conditions by area rather than overall national production.

Sources and Disclaimers: The Crop Monitor assessment is conducted by GEOGLAM with inputs from the following partners (in alphabetical order): Argentina (INTA), Asia Rice Countries (AFSIS, ASEAN+3 & Asia RiCE), Australia (ABARES & CSIRO), Brazil (CONAB & INPE), Canada (AAFC), China (CAS), EU (EC JRC MARS), Indonesia (LAPAN & MOA), International (CIMMYT, FAO, IFPRI & IRRI), Japan (JAXA), Mexico (SIAP), Russia (IKI), South Africa (ARC & GeoTerraImage & SANSA), Thailand (GISTDA & OAE), Ukraine (NASU-NSAU & UHMC), USA (NASA, UMD, USGS – FEWS NET, USDA (FAS, NASS)), Viet Nam (VAST & VIMHE-MARD). The findings and conclusions in this joint multi-agency report are consensual statements from the GEOGLAM experts, and do not necessarily reflect those of the individual agencies represented by these experts. Map data sources: Major crop type areas based on the IFPRI/IIASA SPAM 2005 beta release (2013), USDA/NASS 2013 CDL, 2013 AAFC Annual Crop Inventory Map, GLAM/UMD, GLAD/UMD, Australian Land Use and Management Classification (Version 7), SIAP, ARC, and JRC. Crop calendars based on GEOGLAM partner crop calendars and USDA/FAO crop calendars.

More detailed information on the GEOGLAM crop assessments is available at www.geoglam-crop-monitor.org.

For more information regarding the new crop monitor and pie charts: <http://www.geoglam-crop-monitor.org/about-geoglam-crop-monitor>

Policy Developments

WHEAT

- The Government of **Argentina** approved 1 million tonnes of 2014/15 wheat for export. This adds to a previous authorization to export, starting on 15 December 2015, 1.5 million tonnes of wheat and wheat flour.
- **China** issued import quotas for 2015, while the volume of the tariff rate import quota for 2015 is unchanged at 9.6 million tonnes. In January 2015, 2.5 million tonnes of wheat were sold from government stocks.
- The **Russian Federation** has announced that, starting on 1 February and until 30 June 2015, a combined tax will apply to wheat exports. The tax consists of the addition of EUR 7.50 euros to a 15 percent tax on the customs price, with a minimum set to EUR 35 (USD 40.4) per tonne. Limitations in the transportation and delays in the certification of export grains had applied before this announcement. Intervention tenders in December and January procured over 40 000 tonnes of wheat.
- Government and traders in **Ukraine** have agreed to limit wheat exports to 4.6 million tonnes, of which 1.2 million tonnes of milling wheat, from 1 January to 30 June 2015, with provisions to revise these quantities.

MAIZE

- On 17 December it was announced that **China** had approved the import of the Genetically Modified maize variety MIR162.
- **China** issued import quotas for 2015, while the volume of the tariff rate import quota for 2015 is unchanged at 7.2 million tonnes. The issuance of import quotas is conditional to purchase from domestic stocks. In January 2015, 1.7 million tonnes of maize were sold from government stocks.

RICE

- In December 2014 and January 2015 **Brazil** held quarterly auctions to sell approximately 190 000 tonnes of rice from government reserves.
- **China** issued import quotas for 2015, while the volume of the tariff rate import quota for 2015 is unchanged at 5.3 million tonnes. In a government to government agreement, China will import 150 000 tonnes of rice from Thailand.
- A new Inter-Ministerial Group was setup in **India** to manage food buffer stocks. The volume of food buffer stocks has been revised and open sales and exports of food grains are allowed when existing stocks are in excess of the new volumes.
- Starting January 9, 2015 **Mexico** imposed a 9 percent tariff on imported paddy rice and a 20 percent tariff on husked, long grain and other rice. Tariffs had been eliminated in 2008. Imports from countries under a Free Trade Agreement are exempt.
- **Thailand** has announced its intention to sell through tender 17 million tonnes of rice from government stocks in 2 years, starting on 29 January with 1 million tonnes. Government guaranteed bonds worth THB 100 billion (USD 3 billion) were issued by Thailand's Bank for Agriculture and Agricultural Cooperatives (BAAC) in January 2015. This follows the launch of THB 50 billion (USD 1.5 billion) guaranteed bonds in November to increase the lending capacity of the bank and to repay the government debt to the bank over the previous rice pledging scheme. Low-interest loans will be provided to farmers who hold their harvest, to cover 90 percent of the value of the rice stored, previously 80 percent. An additional subsidy of THB 1 000 (USD 30) per tonne will be paid to farmers.

SOYBEANS

- On 17 December it was announced that **China** had approved the import of the Genetically Modified soybean strains A5547-127 and DP305423.

BIOFUELS

- In **Brazil**, taking effect in May 2015, the mandatory blend of ethanol in commercial petrol will increase, the level is yet to be determined.
- As of 4 January, **France** raised the authorized concentration of biodiesel from 7 percent to 8 percent.
- On 27 January, the **United States** authorized a simplified, third-party operated, renewable tracking programme for Argentinian biodiesel, in lieu of the current record keeping requirement. This responds to a plan submitted on 29 August 2012. The approval may be revoked at any time.

International Prices

International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) and GOI sub-Indices

	Jan- 2015 Average*	% Change	
		M/M	Y/Y
GOI	217	- 4.0%	- 13.5%
Wheat	214	- 6.8%	- 7.2%
Maize	191	- 4.7%	- 14.2%
Rice	168	- 0.7%	- 5.6%
Soybeans	210	- 3.5%	- 19.3%

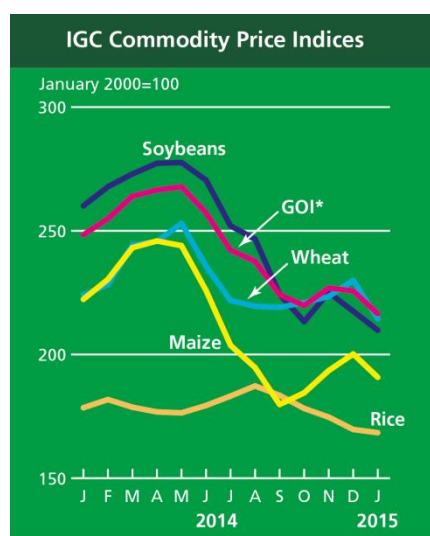
*Jan 2000=100, derived from daily export quotations

Wheat: While worries about export curbs in the Black Sea region contributed to firmer global prices during December, values retreated again in the past month, pressured by ideas that export surpluses elsewhere are more than adequate. Exporters in the EU hoped to benefit from any switch in demand away from Black Sea supplies, with EU price competitiveness aided by currency movements. In the US, the stronger dollar was seen potentially worsening an already slow pace of export sales. A mostly favourable outlook for 2015 world crops added to the softer tone of prices.

Maize: Export quotations were weaker during January, on a comfortable outlook for world supplies, including mostly favourable crop prospects in South America. Losses were also linked to strong export competition, especially for business in Asia, where a drop in ocean freight rates contributed to a pickup in buying interest. Following its approval of MIR162 (Genetically Modified) imports, China was rumoured to have secured some cargoes. Prices in the US were pressured by concerns about future demand for maize-based ethanol production, as industry profit margins are being squeezed by the collapse in crude oil prices.

Rice: World white and parboiled rice markets were mostly weaker in the past month, led by falls in Asia. With key importers well covered and awaiting further price declines, buying interest was subdued. Freshly harvested supplies in leading exporters weighed, as did the Thai government's announcement of a late-January tender to sell 1 million tonne white and fragrant rice from state reserves.

Soybeans: Global soybean export values fell during January, weighed by prospects for record crops in Argentina and Brazil. While firmer than expected buying interest from China and concerns about dryness in South America provided early underpinning, improved crop weather pressured in the second half of the month. External influences, notably firmness of the US dollar, were also bearish at times.



		IGC commodity price indices				
		GOI*	Wheat	Maize	Rice	Soybeans
		(..... January 2000 = 100)				
2014	January	248.4	224.1	222.3	178.5	260.1
	February	254.9	228.2	230.4	181.8	267.8
	March	264.0	244.3	243.2	178.7	273.0
	April	266.5	245.7	245.9	176.8	277.3
	May	267.8	253.0	244.0	176.4	277.6
	June	257.3	235.7	225.9	179.4	270.5
	July	242.2	221.8	203.7	183.2	252.0
	August	237.7	219.5	194.7	187.3	246.7
	September	224.2	219.1	179.8	183.5	224.3
	October	219.8	221.0	184.5	178.2	213.3
	November	226.9	223.4	193.5	174.7	225.1
	December	225.7	230.0	200.2	169.7	217.5
2015	January	216.5	214.4	190.8	168.4	209.8

*GOI: Grains and Oilseeds Index

Futures Markets

Futures Prices

	Jan 2015 Average	% Change	
		M/M	Y/Y
Wheat	200	- 11.6%	- 5.5%
Maize	153	- 1.9%	-8.9%
Rice	246	-7.9%	-28.3%
Soybeans	367	-3.0%	-22.8%

Source: CME

Historical Volatility – 30 Days

	Monthly Averages		
	Jan 2015	Dec 2014	Jan 2014
Wheat (Nearby)	30.6%	29.8%	16.0%
Maize (May)	24.2%	24.1%	19.2%
Rice (Nearby)	21.1%	20.7%	10.9%
Soybeans (Nearby)	22.3%	26.6%	15.7%

Futures Prices

Prices for wheat, maize, soybeans and rice declined m/m as a combination of factors tended to weigh on values. Wheat experienced the largest price decline at around 12 percent. Favorable weather in the US Great Plains and a strengthening US dollar against other currencies overshadowed renewed tensions in the Black Sea region – normally a bullish factor. Maize prices fell about 1 percent as no fundamental changes were perceived for the current abundant supply situation, although strong export sales were said to be supportive. Soybean prices also declined as Brazil's crop, now at maturity, was forecast to be a record, despite dry weather concerns. Argentina's soybean crop was also projected to be record.

Volumes and Volatility

Volumes m/m were mostly unchanged for wheat and soybeans while maize experienced a 40 percent rise – possibly due to seasonal post-new year selling by producers who held a record crop on farm. Implied volatility showed little change except for wheat which registered a small decline m/m.

Forward curves

Forward curves maintained their mostly upward sloping structures (contango) – which have prevailed for over 4 months, indicating ample near term supplies.

Basis levels

Interior basis levels remained mostly at discounts to futures for wheat, maize and soybeans although in localized areas close to ethanol refiners or soy crushing plants, they were elevated for maize and soybeans.

Investment flows

Managed money reduced long positions in wheat, maize and soybeans, citing dollar strength as the main contributing factor coupled with an abundant supply situation. Swaps dealers, representing mostly investment in commodity index funds, also trimmed long positions as part of an overall strategy to reduce commodity exposure in all sectors, particularly energy and industrial metals which have fallen to multi-year lows.

Monthly US Ethanol Update

- Oil prices and gasoline prices have declined substantially over the last few months.
- Ethanol prices have followed oil and gasoline prices lower, but are now at a slight premium to gasoline which last occurred late in 2011.
- Margins for ethanol producers have narrowed significantly with the decline in ethanol prices and the modest strengthening of maize prices.
- DDGS prices are running at 130% of the price of maize as interest in DDGS export sales has picked up and offset a small portion of the decline in ethanol producer margins from falling ethanol prices.
- Falling oil prices are forecast to increase US motorfuel consumption in 2015, the highest level since 2009. Increased motorfuel consumption means increased ethanol use as 10% blends dominate the US market.
- EPA has yet to release 2014 final and 2015 proposed mandate levels.

Spot prices IA, NE and IL/eastern corn belt average	January 2015*	December 2014**	January 2014
---	------------------	--------------------	-----------------

Maize price (USD per tonne)	149.98	149.89	166.52
DDGs (USD per tonne)	196.15	160.58	207.62
Ethanol price (USD per gallon)	1.40	1.90	2.12

Nearby futures prices

CME, NYSE

Ethanol (USD per gallon)	1.45	1.70	1.90
RBOB Gasoline (USD per gallon)	1.36	1.61	2.65
Ethanol/RBOB price ratio	106.4%	105.5%	71.7%

Ethanol margins

IA, NE and IL/eastern corn belt
average, USD per gallon)

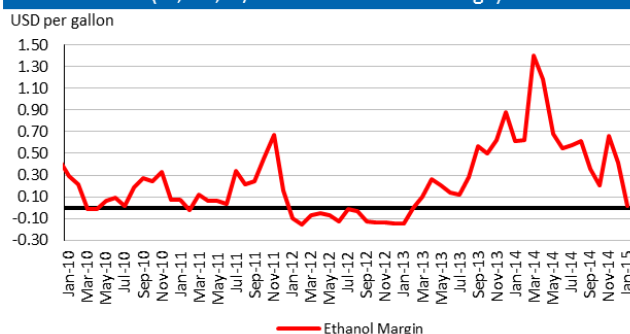
Ethanol receipts	1.40	1.90	2.12
DDGs receipts	0.55	0.45	0.58
Maize costs	1.39	1.38	1.54
Other costs	0.55	0.55	0.55
Production margin	0.02	0.41	0.61

Ethanol production

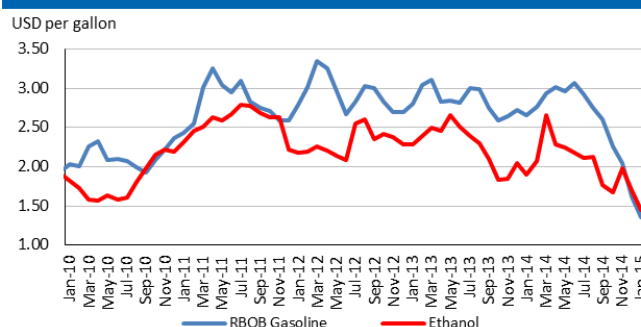
(million gallons)

Monthly production total	1,283	1,289	1,190
Annualized production pace	15,106	15,178	14,017

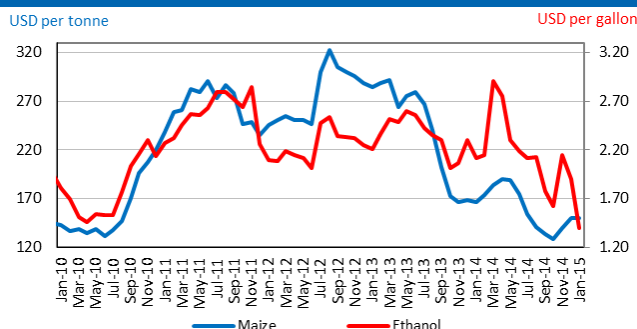
Ethanol production margin
(IA, NE, IL/eastern corn belt average)



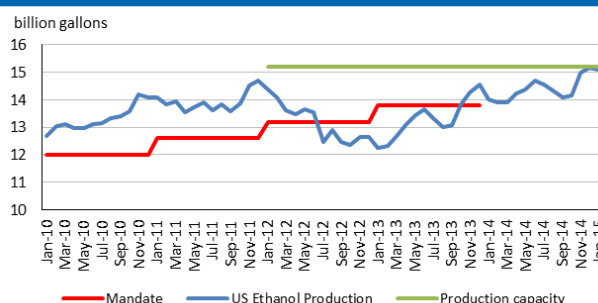
Ethanol and RBOB gasoline
(nearby futures prices, CME, NYSE)



Ethanol price vs. maize price
(Spot prices)



Ethanol production pace, capacity and annual mandate



Based on USDA data and private sources. * Estimated using available weekly data to date.

** Estimated using preliminary weekly data in place of monthly estimates.

Chart and tables description:

Ethanol Production Margins: The ethanol margin gives an indication of the profitability of maize-based ethanol production in the United States. It uses current market prices for maize, Dried Distillers Grains (DDGs) and ethanol, with an additional USD 0.55 per gallon of production costs

Ethanol Production Pace, Capacity and Mandate: Overview of the volume of maize-based ethanol production in the United States; it also highlights overall production capacity and the production volume that is mandated by public legislation. Name-plate (i.e. nominal) ethanol production capacity in the US is roughly 14.9 billion gallons per annum, but plants can exceed this level, so the actual capacity is assumed to be 15.2 billion gallons.

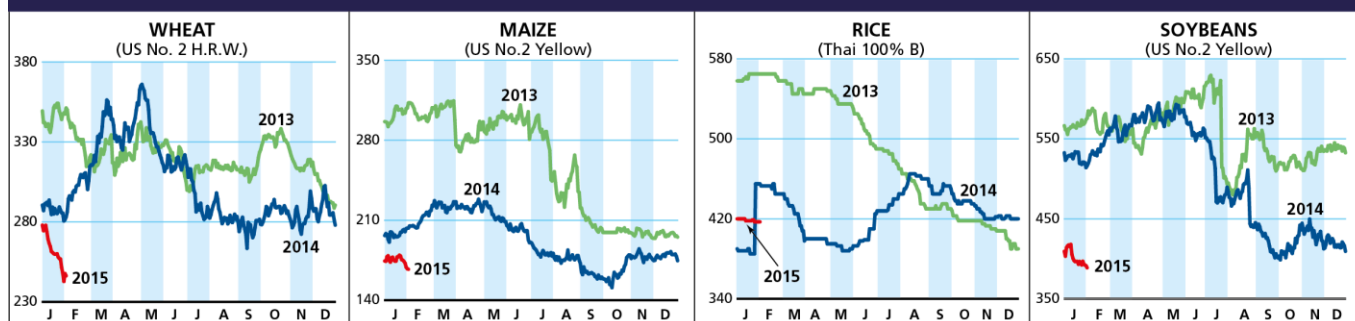
DDGs: By-product of maize-based biofuel production, commonly used as feedstuff.

RBOB: Reformulated Blendstock for Oxygenate Blending, gasoline nearby futures (NYSE).

Supplementary tables and charts

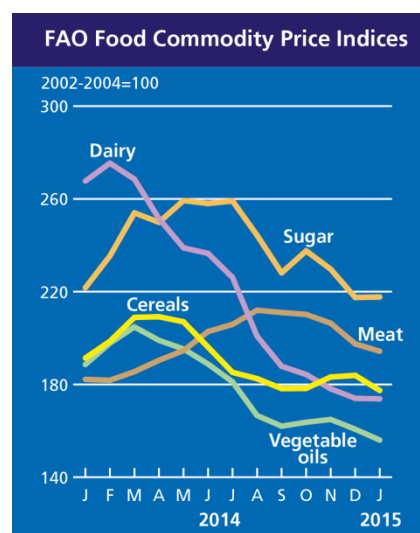
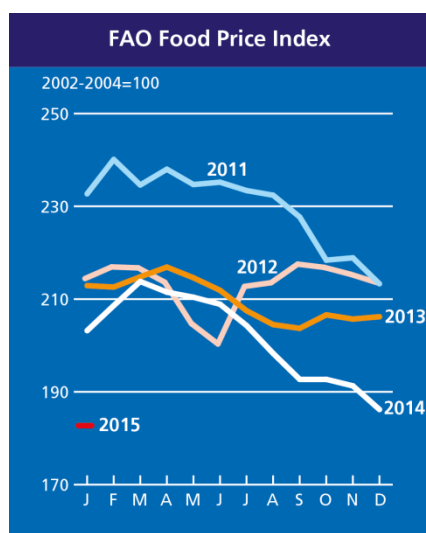
Selected Export Prices and Price Indices

Daily quotations of selected export prices (USD/tonne, 2013-2015)



Daily quotations of selected export prices

	Effective Date	Quotation (1)	Week ago (2)	Month ago (3)	Year ago (4)	% change (1) over (2)	% change (1) over (4)
(..... USD/tonne)							
Wheat (US No. 2, HRW)	02-Feb	245	252	274	286	-2.5%	-14.3%
Maize (US No. 2, Yellow)	03-Feb	175	173	178	203	1.4%	-13.9%
Rice (Thai 100% B)	03-Feb	417	417	420	453	0.0%	-7.9%
Soybeans (US No.2, Yellow)	02-Feb	388	397	403	523	-2.2%	-25.7%



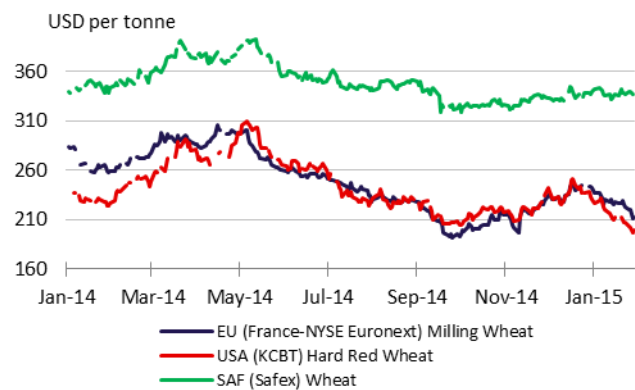
FAO food price indices

Food Price Index		Meat	Dairy	Cereals	Oils and Fats	Sugar
(..... 2002-2004 = 100)						
2014	January	203.2	182.2	267.7	191.4	221.7
	February	208.6	181.8	275.4	198.6	235.4
	March	213.8	185.5	268.5	204.8	254.0
	April	211.5	190.4	251.5	209.2	249.9
	May	210.4	194.6	238.9	207.0	259.3
	June	208.9	202.8	236.5	196.1	258.0
	July	204.3	205.9	226.1	185.2	259.1
	August	198.3	212.0	200.8	182.5	244.3
	September	192.7	211.0	187.8	178.2	228.1
	October	192.7	210.2	184.3	178.3	237.6
	November	191.3	206.4	178.1	183.2	229.7
	December	186.2	197.5	174.0	183.9	217.5
2015	January	182.7	194.3	173.8	177.4	217.7

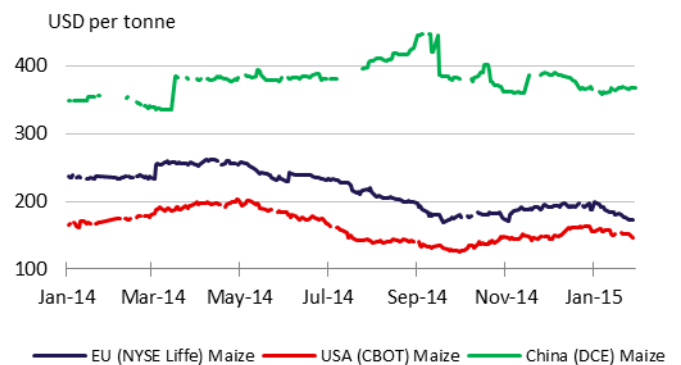
Market Indicators

Daily Quotations from Leading Exchanges - nearby futures

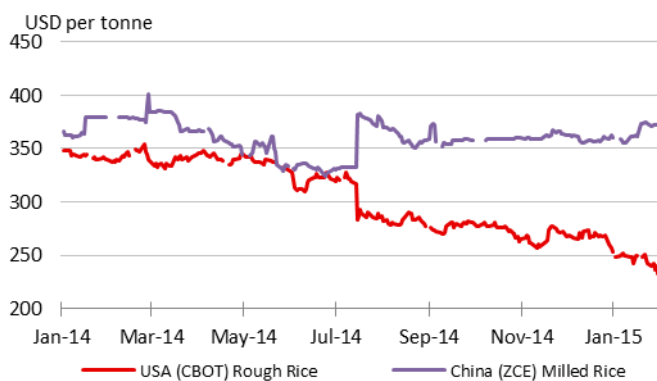
Wheat



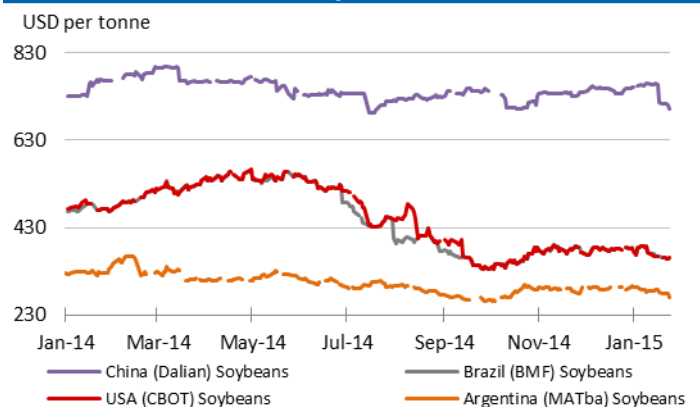
Maize



Rice

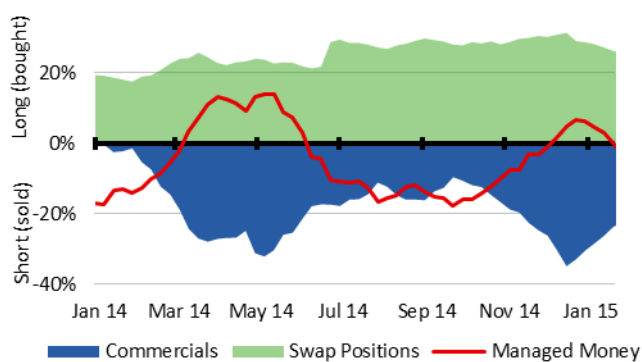


Soybeans

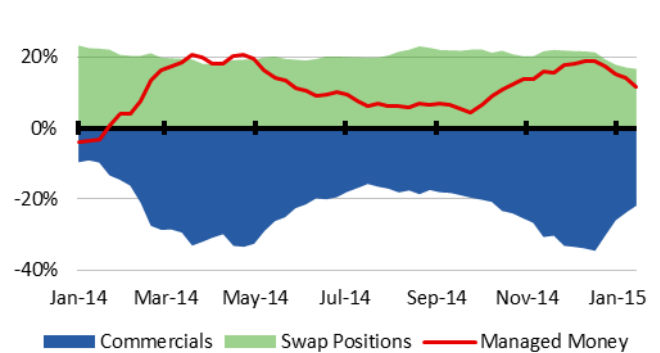


CFTC Commitment of Traders - Major Categories Net Length as % of Open Interest*

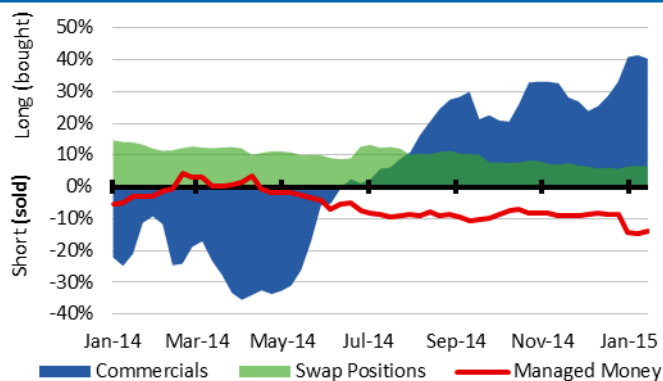
Wheat



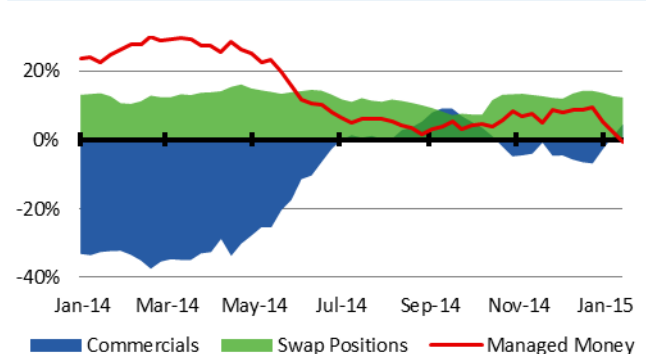
Maize



Rough Rice

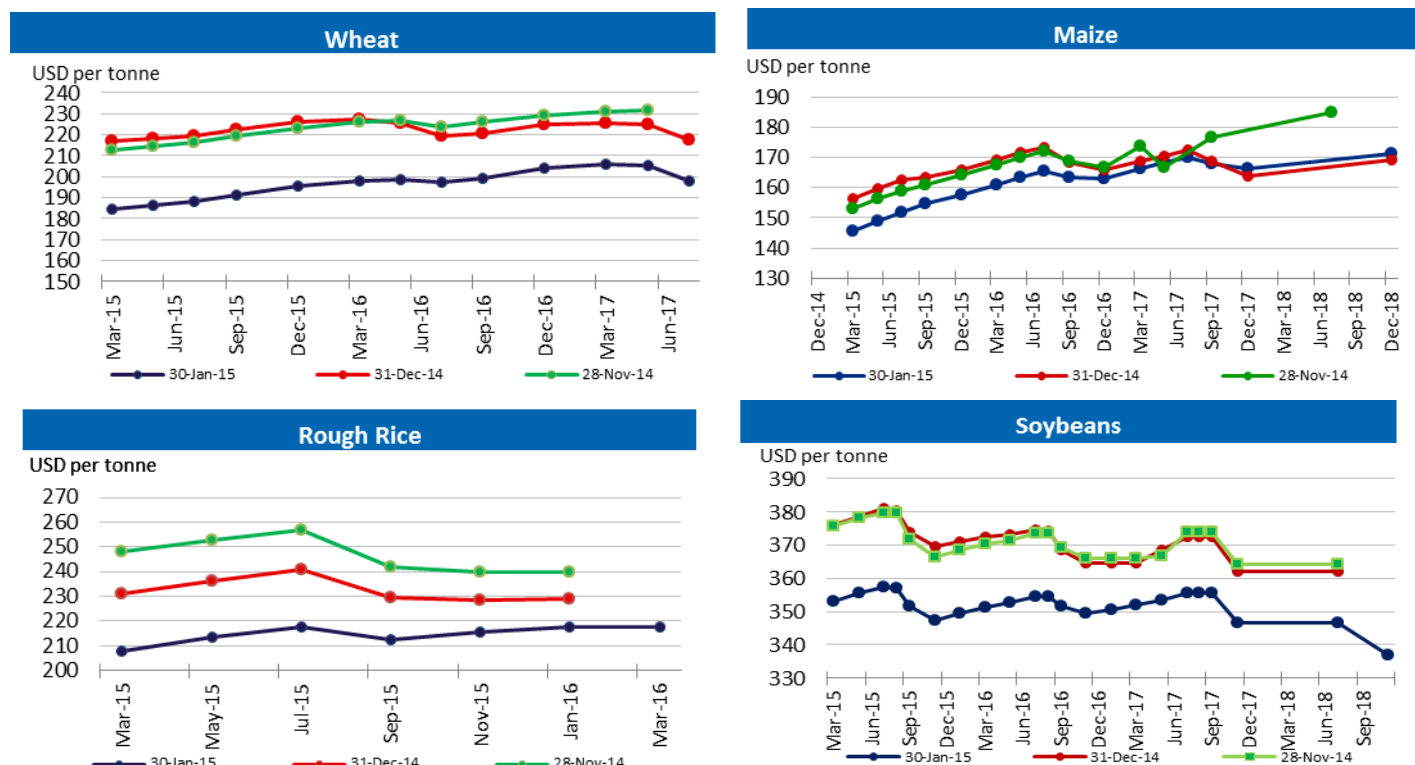


Soybeans

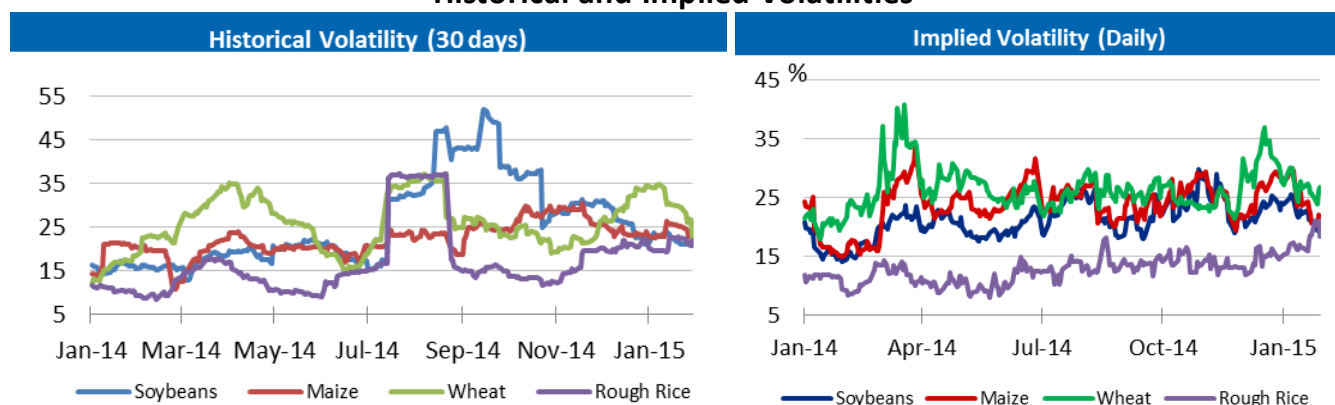


* Disaggregated Futures Only. Though not all positions are reflected in the charts, total long positions always equal total short positions.

Forward Curves



Historical and Implied Volatilities



Maize use for Ethanol in the US

Maize Use for Ethanol (excluding non-fuel) in the United States

	2005/06	2006/07	2007/08	2008/09	2009/10	2010/11	2011/12	2012/13	2013/14* estim.	2014/15* (fcast)
	thousand tonnes									
Maize Production	282,263	267,503	331,177	307,142	332,550	316,166	313,956	273,188	351,270	361,101
Ethanol Use	40,726	53,837	77,453	93,396	116,616	127,538	127,005	117,886	130,409	131,323
Yearly ethanol use change(%)	21%	32%	44%	21%	25%	9.4%	-0.4%	-7.2%	10.6%	0.7%
As Production (%)	14%	20%	23%	30%	35%	40.3%	40.5%	43.1%	37.2%	36.4%

Source: WASDE-USDA. * 12 January 2015

AMIS Market Indicators

Some of the indicators covered in this report are updated regularly on the AMIS website. These, as well as other market indicators, can be found at:

<http://www.amis-outlook.org/amis-monitoring/indicators/>

Explanatory Notes and Calendar

The notions of **tightening** and **easing** used in the summary table of “World Supply and Demand” reflect judgmental views which take into account market fundamentals, inter-alia price developments and short-term trends in demand and supply, especially changes in stocks.

All totals (aggregates) are computed from unrounded data. World supply and demand estimates/forecasts in this report are based on the latest data published by FAO, IGC and USDA; for the former, they also take into account information received from AMIS countries (hence the notion “FAO-AMIS”). World estimates and forecasts may vary due to several reasons. Apart from different release dates, the three main sources may apply different methodologies to construct the elements of the balances. Specifically:

Production: For wheat, production data refer to the first year of the marketing season shown (e.g. the 2014 production is allocated to the 2014/15 marketing season). For maize and rice, FAO-AMIS production data refer to the season corresponding to the first year shown, as for wheat. However, in the case of rice, 2014 production also includes secondary crops gathered in 2015. By contrast, for rice and maize, USDA and IGC aggregate production of the northern hemisphere of the first year (e.g. 2014) with production of the southern hemisphere of the second year (2015 production) in the corresponding 2014/15 global marketing season. For soybeans, this latter method is used by all three sources.

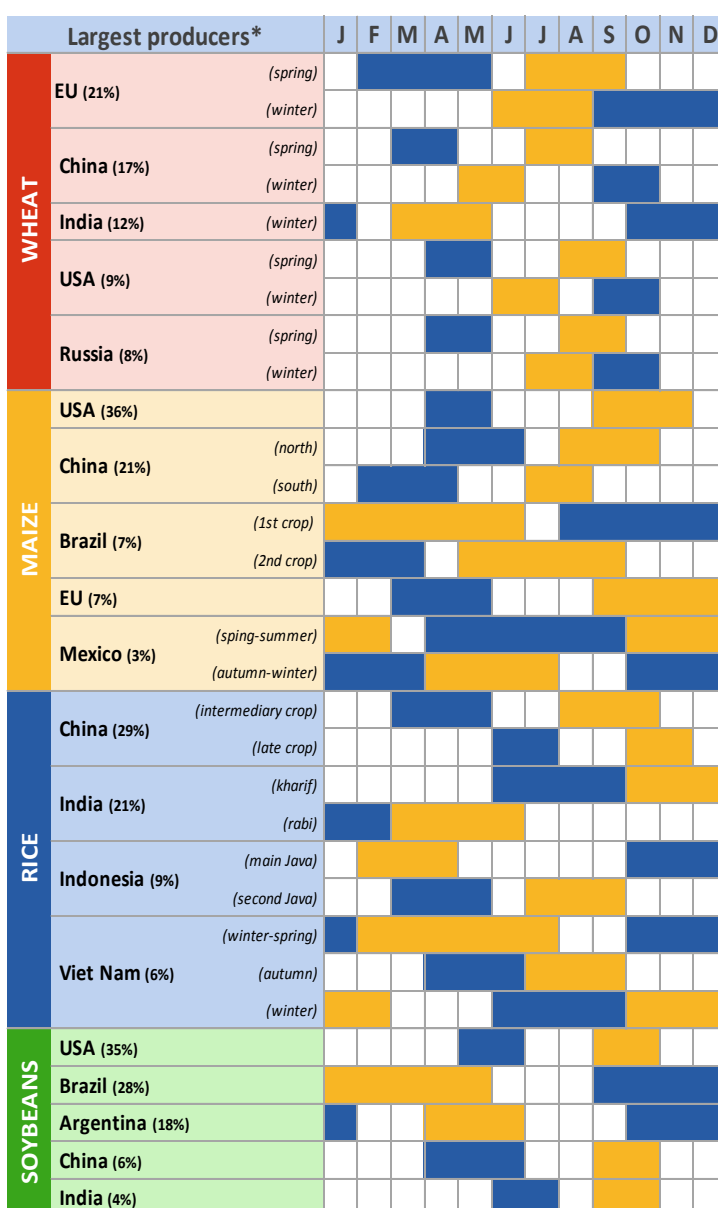
Supply: Defined as production plus opening stocks. No major differences across sources.

Utilization: For wheat, maize and rice, utilization includes food, feed and other uses (“other uses” comprise seeds, industrial utilization and post-harvest losses). For soybeans, it comprises crush, food and other uses. No major differences across sources.

Trade: Data refer to exports. For wheat and maize, trade is reported on a July/June marketing year basis, except for the USDA maize trade estimates, which are reported on an October/September basis. For rice, trade covers flows from January to December of the second year shown, and for soybeans from October to September. Trade between European Union member states is excluded.

Ending Stocks: In general, ending stocks refer to the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country’s national marketing year. In the case of maize and rice, in southern hemisphere countries the definition of the national marketing year is not the same across the three sources as it depends on the methodology chosen to allocate production. For Soybeans, the USDA world stock level is based on an aggregate of stock levels as of 31 August for all countries, coinciding with the end of the US marketing season. By contrast, the IGC and FAO-AMIS measure of world stocks is the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country’s national marketing year.

AMIS Crop Calendar



* The percentages refer to the global share of production (average 2008-12).

Planting Harvesting

Main sources

Bloomberg, CFTC, CME Group, FAO, GEOGLAM, Inter-Continental Exchange, IGC, Reuters, USDA, US Federal Reserve, World Bank

2015 Release Dates

05 February, 05 March, 02 April, 07 May, 04 June, 09 July, 10 September, 08 October, 05 November, 03 December

Contacts and Subscriptions

AMIS Secretariat

Email: AMIS-Secretariat@fao.org

Download the AMIS Market Monitor or get a free e-mail subscription at:

<http://www.amis-outlook.org/amis-monitoring>